

HIGH-END SMARTPHONES (₹40,001 TO ₹70,000)

High-end smartphones have to be GREAT to be noticeable in 2024, because mid-range smartphones are becoming increasingly capable. Here, a smartphone of your dreams must offer a flagship-grade camera, the latest generative AI features, and a clean software experience. Most phones we have recommended offer that, except one, the iQOO 12. But what it does offer is raw power beyond any mid-ranger, which is close to or even surpasses flagships of 2024. Here are the features you must keep in mind when you are buying a high-end phone:

- **AI Features** - AI is all the rage in 2024 and AI features will be indispensable to most in the coming years. If you are spending over ₹40K on a phone, it should have a good NPU that can support existing and future AI features. Also, look for phones with AI features out of the box. Check reviews to know how well they work.
- **Great Cameras** - Robust camera hardware with incredible computational photography is the future of smartphone photography. Ensure that the sensor is large enough to let in enough light for low-light photography, it has OIS and EIS, and has strong secondary and tertiary cameras. In this price range, you'd typically look for a strong primary camera, with an ultrawide and a telephoto/periscope lens.
- **Seamless Software** - You are often going to come across phones with incredible features and specs, but bloated UIs. However, high-end phones must have clean softwares to facilitate a seamless user experience. Some great UIs on phones at this budget are NothingOS, Motorola's HelloUI, and the Pixel Launcher/Stock Android.

PREMIUM SMARTPHONES (OVER ₹70,000)

In a premium or flagship smartphone, there's no room for any cost-cutting measures. They have to stand out. Here are some things you should not negotiate on:

- **All of the above** - Every single feature mentioned above should be on your radar at this price range.
- **Premium Features** - You must also

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR BUDGET SMARTPHONES



Xiaomi Redmi 12 5G
Price: ₹11,999



Realme P1
Price: ₹15,999



POCO X6 5G
Price: ₹18,999



iQOO Z9
Price: ₹19,999



realme NARZO 70 Pro
Price: ₹19,999

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR HIGH-END SMARTPHONES



Vivo V30 Pro
Price: ₹41,999



Xiaomi 14 CIVI
Price: ₹42,999



Google Pixel 8a
Price: ₹52,999



iQOO 12 5G
Price: ₹52,999



Motorola Edge 50 Ultra
Price: ₹59,999

look for other quality of life features such as fast wireless charging, at least an IP68 rating, premium materials, tons of AI features, and other niceties like a stylus.

- **Ecosystem Perks** - Many OEMs like Apple and Samsung offer a comprehen-

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR MID-RANGE SMARTPHONES



Motorola Edge 50 Fusion
Price: ₹22,999



Nothing Phone (2a)
Price: ₹23,999



POCO F6
Price: ₹29,999



iQOO Neo9 Pro 5G
Price: ₹36,999



OnePlus 12R
Price: ₹39,998

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR PREMIUM SMARTPHONES



Vivo X100 Pro
Price: ₹89,999



Xiaomi 14 Ultra
Price: ₹99,999



Samsung Galaxy S24 Ultra
Price: ₹129,999



OnePlus Open
Price: ₹139,999



iPhone 15 Pro Max
Price: ₹148,900

sive range of accompanying products that seamlessly integrate into their ecosystem. This enhances convenience and functionality, making it a significant consideration when choosing a flagship smartphone in 2024. **[d]**